

1) User Experience Aspects I Like In Microsoft Teams

1. Integrates well with Microsoft Office 365, enabling easy sharing of documents, spreadsheets, and presentations.
2. The ability to create multiple channels within a team for specific topics or projects improves collaboration.
3. Features like meeting scheduling, recording, and transcript generation enhance productivity.
4. Built-in file sharing and version history simplify document collaboration.
5. Strong search features for quickly finding messages, files, or people.
6. Ability to respond to messages directly from notifications without opening the full app enhances user convenience.
7. Simultaneous editing of documents during meetings or chats fosters teamwork and productivity.
8. Clear indicators of user availability (online, busy, away) simplify communication and scheduling.

Suggested Improvements for Microsoft Teams

1. Enhance offline functionality by allowing users to draft messages, access more files, and view past conversations.
2. Allow granular control over notifications, such as muting certain keywords or receiving alerts for specific messages.
3. Provide better tools to organize, filter, and search shared files within channels, including tagging and categorization.
4. Simplify navigation by reducing clutter and offering more intuitive placement of commonly used features.
5. Optimize the mobile app for better battery performance and ensure all desktop functionalities (like creating new channels or managing permissions) are available on mobile.
6. Improve application speed and reduce memory consumption, especially for older systems or when multiple apps are running concurrently.

2) USE CASES:

Heavy Use Case 1: Enhancement of Offline Mode

Actor: Microsoft Teams User

Use Case Overview: Users should be able to draft messages, view past conversations, and access files while offline.

Subject Area: Communication and Productivity

Trigger: User loses internet connectivity while working.

Precondition 1: User has logged into Teams at least once with an active internet connection.

Precondition 2: Files and conversations must be synced prior to going offline.

Basic Flow:

1. User loses internet connectivity.
2. Open Microsoft Teams in offline mode.
3. Drafts a message for individual or group chat.
4. Accesses recently viewed conversations and synced files.
5. Saves any edits or updates locally.
6. Reconnects to the internet, and all changes (messages and file edits) are automatically synced to the cloud.

Alternate Flow A: User tries to access unsynced files.

- System notifies the user that the file is unavailable and provides an option to queue the request for when the internet connection is restored.

Alternate Flow B: User drafts a message offline.

- Upon reconnection, the message is automatically sent to the intended recipient.

Postconditions:

- User productivity is maintained even without an active internet connection.

Heavy Use Case 2: Customizable Notifications

Actor: Microsoft Teams User

Use Case Overview: Users should be able to configure granular notification settings for specific keywords, mentions, or message types.

Subject Area: Notifications and Alerts

Trigger: User needs to stay updated on critical messages while muting non-essential ones.

Precondition 1: User has Teams installed and configured.

Precondition 2: User has active chats, groups, or channels with ongoing messages.

Basic Flow:

1. User navigates to the notification settings menu in Teams.
2. Configures settings to:
 - Mute certain keywords (e.g. trivial).
 - Enable alerts for specific keywords (e.g. deadline).
 - Customize sound and visual alerts.
3. Saves the settings.
4. Receives notifications based on the configured preferences.

Alternate Flow A: User sets notifications for specific channels.

- System alerts the user only for high-priority channels while muting others.

Alternate Flow B: User customizes notification preferences for mentions only.

- System sends alerts only when the user is mentioned in a conversation.

Postconditions:

- Users are notified only about relevant messages, reducing distractions.

Medium Use Case 1: Enhanced File Tagging and Categorization

Topic: Simplified File Management

Actor: Microsoft Teams User

Use Case Overview: Users can tag and categorize shared files for easy filtering and retrieval.

Basic Flow:

1. User navigates to the "Files" tab in a channel.
2. Selects a file and clicks on "Add Tags."
3. Enters tags (e.g., "Proposal," "Q1 Reports") and assigns categories.
4. Uses the search bar to filter files by tags, categories, or both.
5. Locates and opens the desired file efficiently.

Alternate Flow A: User tags multiple files at once.

- Selects multiple files and assigns the same tags or categories in bulk.

Alternate Flow B: User searches for a file with an incorrect or partial tag.

- System suggests similar or related tags to refine the search results.

Postconditions: Users can organize and retrieve files quickly, improving collaboration and productivity.

Medium Use Case 2: Customizable Navigation Bar

Topic: Streamlined User Interface

Actor: Microsoft Teams User

Use Case Overview: Users can customize the navigation bar to prioritize commonly used features.

Basic Flow:

1. User accesses the "Customize Navigation" option in Teams settings.
2. Drags and drops features (e.g., Chat, Calendar, Files) to reorder the navigation bar.
3. Saves changes, and the customized layout is applied immediately.
4. Frequently used features are now accessible with fewer clicks.

Alternate Flow A: User resets the navigation bar to the default layout.

- Selects "Reset to Default" from the settings menu.

Alternate Flow B: User adds a shortcut for an external app or webpage to the navigation bar.

- Enters the URL or selects the app, and it appears in the bar.

Postconditions: Navigation is more intuitive and tailored to individual user needs, reducing time spent searching for features.

Simple Use Case Title: Quick File Preview in Teams

Actor: Microsoft Teams User

Basic Flow:

1. User navigates to the "Files" tab in a chat or channel.
2. Clicks on a file to open a quick preview without downloading or opening it in a separate application.
3. User reviews the content of the file (e.g. document, spreadsheet, or presentation).
4. Closes the preview and returns to the "Files" tab.

Postconditions:

- User can quickly view the file's content without leaving Teams or downloading the file.